
The Platonic Brain: Representational Convergence in EEG Foundation Models

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Abstract

1 The Platonic Representation Hypothesis (PRH) predicts that artificial neural net-
2 works converge on shared representations as scale and performance increase. We
3 test whether these predictions hold for representations of the human brain with
4 EEG foundation models. Using EEG recordings from six participants watching
5 a television series, together with aligned visual and language content, we tested
6 whether EEG foundation-model representations converge within and across modal-
7 ities as their embeddings become better at decoding an informative set of EEG
8 markers. We found that EEG models with greater decodability showed stronger
9 cross-family alignment in both local neighbourhood similarity and global structure,
10 not consistently increasing with model parameter count. Cross-modal convergence
11 was modality and metric dependent: greater EEG decodability was associated
12 with stronger global alignment to language, but not consistently to vision models,
13 while local alignment showed no consistent association. This dissociation may
14 reflect local sensitivity to low-level sensory features, whereas global geometry may
15 capture weaker shared semantic structure.

16 1 Introduction

17 The Platonic Representation Hypothesis (PRH) proposes that artificial neural networks develop
18 increasingly convergent latent representations as model scale and performance increase Huh et al.
19 [2024]. This convergence has been interpreted as evidence that sufficiently trained models are capable
20 of recovering the shared statistical structure of the world. Several mechanisms have been proposed
21 to explain this effect, including task generality, simplicity bias, and model capacity. As models are
22 trained on increasingly diverse tasks and data, the set of representations capable of satisfying all
23 relevant constraints may become progressively smaller.

24 More recently, the PRH has been refined by the Aristotelian Representation Hypothesis (ARH),
25 which argues that increasing architecture depth or width can systematically inflate representational
26 similarity scores [Gröger et al., 2026]. The ARH therefore introduces a null-calibration that corrects
27 representational similarity metrics for scale-induced inflation. Applying this calibration, it was shown
28 that global convergence in overall geometry largely disappears, while local agreement on nearest
29 neighbors persists. Empirical support for both the PRH and ARH has mainly come from vision
30 and language models, although their predictions have recently begun to be examined in other data
31 modalities [Borrell et al., 2026, Yashwante and Yu, 2026].

32 A further prediction of the PRH is that increasingly capable artificial models should become more
33 aligned with neural representations in the human brain. Human information processing is thought
34 to be hierarchically organized, with low-level sensory features progressively transformed into more
35 abstract semantic representations, some of which generalize across sensory modalities [DiCarlo et al.,

2012, Grill-Spector and Malach, 2004, Patterson et al., 2007, Lambon Ralph et al., 2017]. These semantic representations have also been linked to the distributional structure of language: concepts that occur in similar linguistic contexts tend to elicit similar neural representations [Harris, 1954, Mitchell et al., 2008]. Thus, insofar as convergence among artificial neural networks reflects common statistical structure in the world, their representations may also converge toward the transmodal semantic representations encoded by the human brain.

This prediction can be tested by comparing representations learned by artificial neural networks with those measured from human neuroimaging data during sensory processing. Electroencephalography (EEG) is particularly well suited to investigating the temporal correspondence between neural and artificial representations because it offers high temporal resolution, is cost-effective and supports large-scale data acquisition. However, interpreting increasing artificial–neural alignment as evidence for representational convergence requires first establishing whether independently trained models of EEG itself become increasingly aligned as their scale and performance increase. Whether such intramodal convergence occurs for learned EEG representations remains an open question.

Here, we investigate whether the predictions of the PRH extend to foundation models trained directly on EEG recordings, which can now be pretrained on tens of thousands of hours of brain activity spanning multiple subjects and recording montages [Tegon et al., 2025, Döner et al., 2025, Jiang et al., 2025, El Ouahidi et al., 2025, Yang et al., 2026]. Specifically, we ask whether EEG foundation models converge on similar representations as their performance improves (intramodal convergence), and whether this convergence extends beyond EEG to representations learned by vision and language models (crossmodal convergence).

2 Setup

Data. We use CineBrain [Gao et al., 2025], which includes EEG and fMRI from six subjects (four women, two men; aged 21–26) watching the same 180 minutes of the television series *The Big Bang Theory*. The EEG data was divided into non-overlapping windows of length determined by the epochs used to train each foundation model. Each window is paired with the visual stimulus the subjects saw and with the CineBrain scene captions covering it. Preprocessing details for both modalities are in App. A.

Models. For EEG we use 14 models from five families: FEMBA [Tegon et al., 2025], LUNA [Döner et al., 2025], NeuroLM [Jiang et al., 2025], ST-EEGFormer [Yang et al., 2026] and REVE [El Ouahidi et al., 2025]. For vision we use DINOv2 [Oquab et al., 2023], V-JEPA 2 [Assran et al., 2025], and VideoMAE together with its Kinetics-finetuned version [Tong et al., 2022]. For language we use BLOOMZ [Muennighoff et al., 2023] and OpenLLaMA [Geng and Liu, 2023], applied to the captions of each window. All models are frozen. Embedding extraction is detailed in App. A.

Metrics. Two representations can be similar in two ways: they may share local neighbourhood structure or exhibit similar global pairwise-similarity structure. Following Huh et al. [2024] and Gröger et al. [2026], we use mutual k -nearest-neighbour overlap (mKNN) at $k = 5$ for the local question and linear CKA [Kornblith et al., 2019] for the global one. For each pair of models we report the best score over layer pairs.

Metrics calibration. To calibrate the similarity metrics, we introduce a null model taking into account the temporal smoothness in the data. The i.i.d. permutation of Gröger et al. [2026] would destroy that time correlation, drawing the null from a distribution with strictly less structure than the data, so it understates the baseline and overstates significance. Their framework is stated over an arbitrary permutation group, so we keep it and use the cyclic group of circular shifts, rigidly rotating one signal against the other. This breaks the correspondence between the two while leaving each one’s own temporal structure intact, so what survives is content-specific alignment rather than shared smoothness. We state this formally in App. B.

A task-free Quality axis. Testing whether capability predicts alignment requires a measure of model performance for a relevant task, as in Huh et al. [2024] and Gröger et al. [2026]. Vision and language offer both a direct measure, such as ImageNet accuracy or bits per byte, and an indirect measure in model size, which scaling laws tie to loss and downstream performance [Kaplan et al.,

2020, Hoffmann et al., 2022]. EEG models have neither: they are orders of magnitude smaller and no scaling law relates their size to performance, and Yang et al. [2026] find performance varying widely across downstream tasks. Due to this variability across tasks, we focus on the decodability of very general EEG features that are consistently informative about global brain state across cognitive tasks and populations [Sitt et al., 2014, Engemann et al., 2018]: band power, spectral entropy, median and edge frequency, permutation entropy, and Hjorth mobility and complexity. Each marker is predicted by ridge regression, cross-validated over contiguous blocks so nearby windows never fall on both sides of a split, and a model’s score is its mean over markers. We define *NICE decodability* as the mean cross-validated R^2 with which a model’s embeddings predict these markers. Details in App. C.

Comparing within a family. The five model families differ in architecture, pretraining data, and objective, producing family-specific baselines in both decodability and representational alignment. To isolate the within-family association, we defined each model’s alignment as its mean calibrated similarity to models from other families and subtracted the corresponding family mean from both alignment and EEG decodability. We then computed Spearman’s correlation across these family-centred values.

3 Results

3.1 Intramodality Alignment

Model alignment predicts EEG markers decodability. As a further test of the predictions put forward by the PRH, we next tested whether models with greater NICE decodability aligned more strongly with models from other EEG families¹. For each model, we averaged its excess alignment over the cyclic-null mean across all cross-family comparisons and mean-centred both alignment and decodability within family (Figure 1). There, each panel asks: *within a family, do models with greater marker decodability align more with other families?*

Decodability correlated positively with both mKNN ($p = 0.003$) and CKA ($p = 0.007$), consistent with the predictions of the PRH². At the pairwise level, 78/78 mKNN and 75/78 CKA comparisons exceeded the cyclic null at $p < 0.05$.

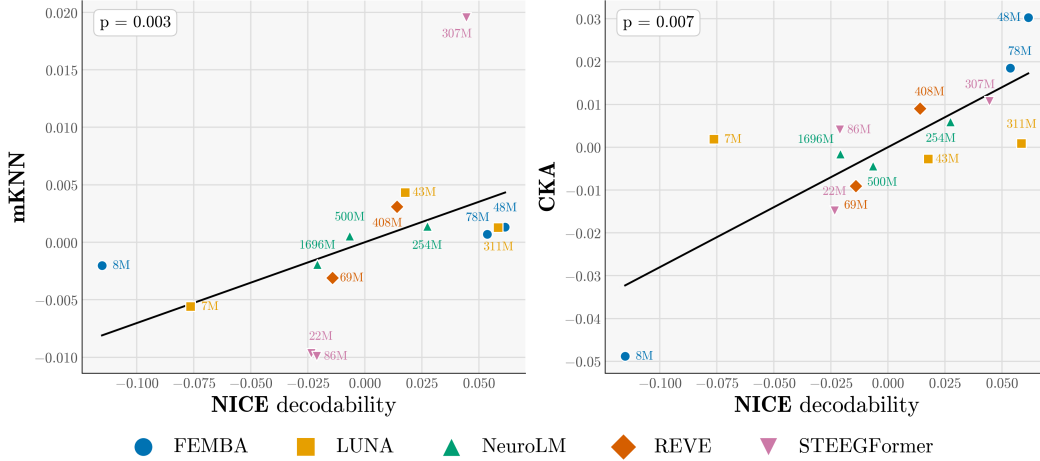


Figure 1: Intra-modality alignment correlates with model capability. Individual points denote models; shape and colour indicate family, and labels indicate parameter count. *Vertical axis*: alignment after subtracting results obtained using the null model (App. B), averaged over that model’s alignments to every model outside its own family for the mKNN (left) and CKA (right). *Horizontal axis*: NICE decodability. Both axes are mean-centred within family. Alignments are computed on subject-averaged embeddings resampled to the shared 10 s windows ($n = 1080$).

¹As a preliminary analysis, we compared adjacent model-size pairs within each family (App. E). Calibrated mKNN increased from the smaller to the larger pair in every family, whereas CKA showed no consistent increase. Because models within a family share architectures, training data, and objectives, we excluded these comparisons from the main analysis for both metrics.

²Parameter count did not consistently order the models. For EEG models, size appears not to be a proxy for model quality.

3.2 Crossmodality Alignment: Vision and Language

The cyclic null introduced in Sec. 2 and applied to the within-EEG analysis in Figure 1 was also used for all cross-modal comparisons. Figure 2 illustrates its effect in this setting. Raw mKNN between FEMBA and DINOv2 increases with EEG model size, but the cyclic-null baseline increases at a comparable rate. In this case every cell except one clears the null model, so the alignment is real, but the excess over the null model does not increase with model size. Thus, raw alignment against model size cannot by itself establish cross-modal convergence. All model-pair comparisons are in App. G

We therefore tested cross-modal convergence using the same null-centred alignment and NICE-decoding axis as in Figure 1. Figure 3 shows alignment with V-JEPA2 and BLOOMZ, averaged across the sizes of each partner family, so the question now is: *do models with greater decodability align more strongly with the vision and language representations?* Results against VideoMAE, VideoMAE-K400, DinoV2 and OpenLLaMa are presented in App F.

Alignment does not consistently correlate with NICE decodability for either vision or language models when measured with mKNN. In contrast, CKA shows a more consistent relationship with decodability, particularly for language models. This suggests a dissociation between local and global measures of representational similarity: the relationship between alignment and decodability is apparent at the level captured by CKA, but is not consistent when measuring local alignment between models using mKNN.

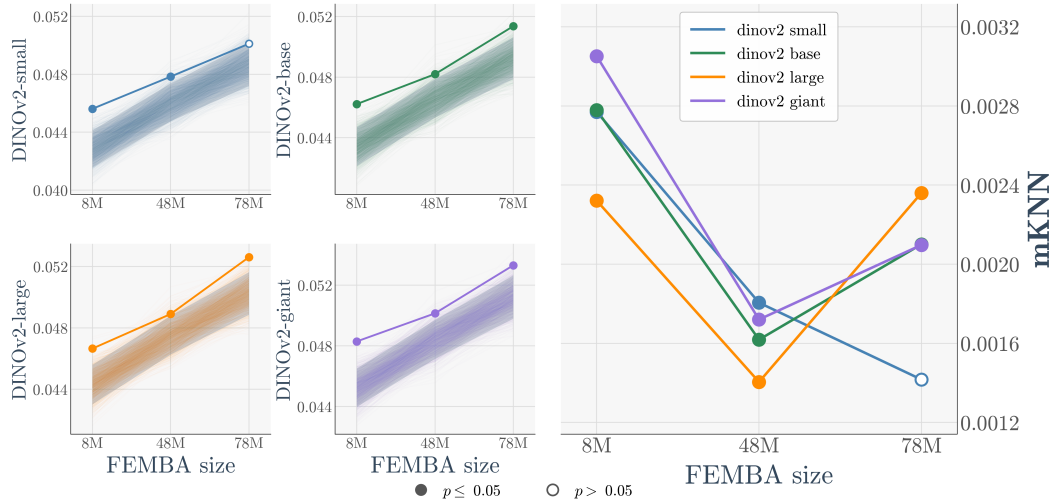


Figure 2: Cross-modal alignment increases due to heightened model sensitivity to temporal correlations and not because of model scaling *Left:* observed mKNN for FEMBA–DINOv2 pairs (solid coloured lines) and alignment under circular shifts (translucent lines; shaded 5th–95th percentile interval). Filled markers indicate comparisons with $p \leq 0.05$ under the cyclic-shift test. *Right:* Calibrated alignment for each pair. Although raw alignment increases with FEMBA size, the null-centred value does not increase consistently. All models pairs comparison are presented in Figures 7 and 8.

4 Discussion and limitations

We found that representations of EEG foundation models become more similar as these models increase their capability to decode a highly informative set of EEG markers. This was observed within and across families, and was not directly related to model size, reflecting solely their performance.

Additionally, cross-modal convergence was metric and modality dependent. Global alignment correlated strongly with decodability for language models and more weakly for some vision models, whereas local alignment showed no consistent association. One possible explanation is that low-level sensory features dominate local EEG neighbourhoods, whereas CKA summarizes global geometry across all samples and may therefore capture weaker, distributed similarities associated with shared semantic content. This interpretation is consistent with our data but was not tested directly.

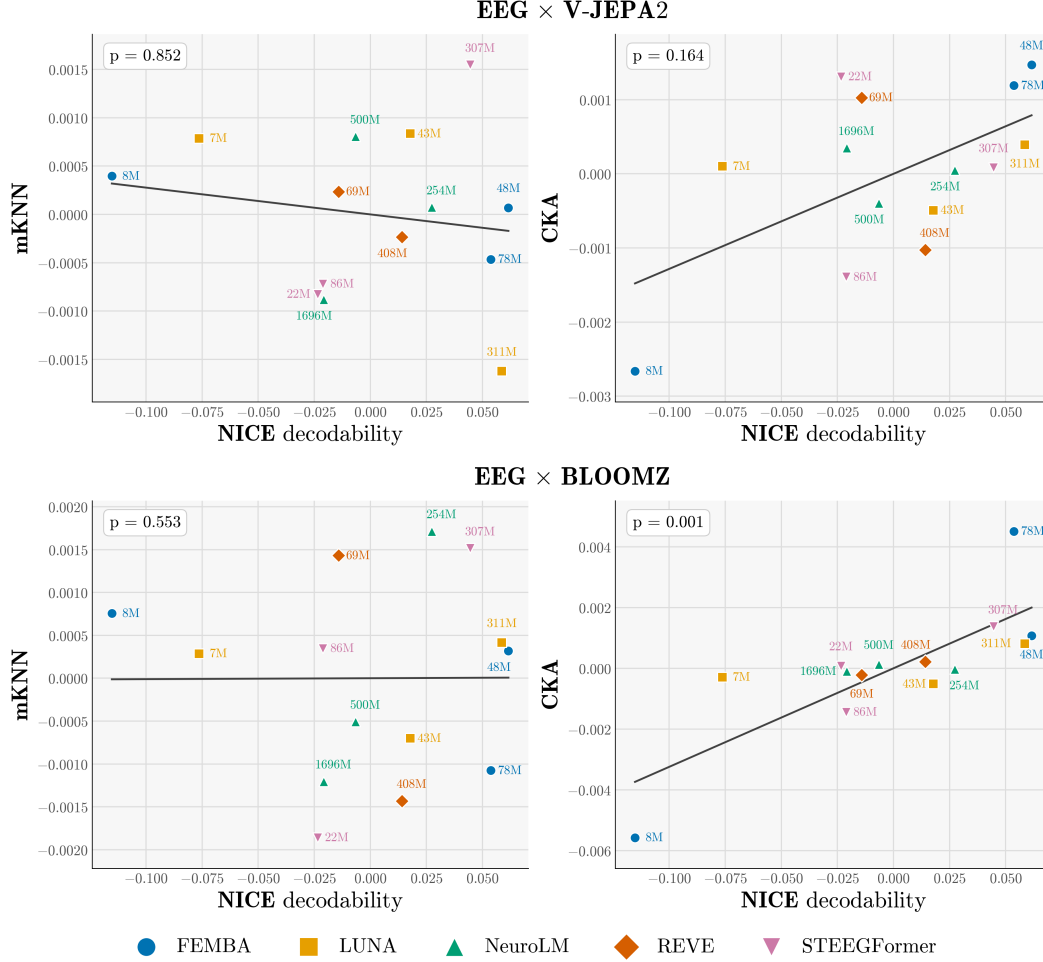


Figure 3: Cross-modality global alignment correlates with model capability Individual points denote models; shape and colour indicate family, and labels indicate parameter count. *Vertical axis:* alignment after subtracting results obtained using the null model (App. B), and averaged for each EEG model across all sizes of the corresponding vision or language model family for the mKNN (left) and CKA (right). *Horizontal axis:* NICE decodability. Both axes are mean-centred within family. Each EEG model is paired with the partner tiled at its own window length on subject-averaged EEG embeddings.

Our results and conclusions contain clear limitations. The analyses included only 14 models from five families and six participants, limiting statistical power. Also, neighbourhood similarity between EEG and video or language representations exceeded the time-shifted control only modestly, suggesting that part of the observed alignment may reflect shared temporal smoothness rather than content-specific structure. Finally, all analyses relied on a single dataset, limiting the generalisability of our conclusions.

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239 A Preprocessing

240 **Data and windowing.** We use Season 7 of CineBrain [Gao et al., 2025], the first ten episodes,
 241 which all six subjects share: 10 800 s stored as 13 500 consecutive 0.8 s frames. The EEG is recorded
 242 with a 64-channel GSN-HydroCel cap at 1000 Hz and distributed band-pass filtered to 0.1–30 Hz
 243 with a 50 Hz notch; the fMRI is distributed as one flat masked-voxel vector of 18 946 dimensions per
 244 repetition time (TR = 0.8 s), already z-scored and not atlas-parcellated. Both share the same 0.8 s
 245 frame grid, on which a 4 s video clip c covers frames $[5c, 5c + 5)$. We take both releases as distributed
 246 and add no cleaning of our own: no independent component analysis, no artefact rejection, no channel
 247 interpolation, and no re-referencing beyond the montages individual models require, so every window
 248 of every subject enters the analysis. All representations live on non-overlapping windows tiling
 249 the recording from $t = 0$, with the length L fixed by a window consistent with the ones used in
 250 pretraining for each EEG model family: 5 s for FEMBA and LUNA ($W = 2160$ windows), 6 s for
 251 ST-EEGFormer ($W = 1800$), 8 s for NeuroLM ($W = 1350$), 10 s for REVE ($W = 1080$), and a 4 s
 252 clip-native grid ($W = 2700$) where no EEG model is involved.

253 **EEG.** Each model receives the input format of its own pretraining pipeline. FEMBA and LUNA
 254 use the 22 bipolar pairs of the TUEG double-banana montage at 256 Hz, the former with per-channel
 255 interquartile-range normalisation and clipping to $[-20, 20]$, the latter z-scored per channel and
 256 window; NeuroLM uses 64 channels at 200 Hz, rescaled to the microvolt range of its training data
 257 and tokenised as 64 channels $\times$ 8 patches of 200 samples; ST-EEGFormer uses 62 channels at
 258 128 Hz, z-scored per channel; REVE uses 64 channels at 200 Hz, band-passed 0.5–99 Hz, z-scored
 259 per channel over the full session and clipped at $\pm 15\sigma$. The models therefore do not all see the same
 260 electrodes, and the two band-passes are inert given the 30 Hz low-pass of the data. For each model
 261 we extract the hidden state of every block and mean-pool it over tokens, giving one vector per layer,
 262 window and subject.

263 **fMRI.** Treating fMRI as a representation rather than a target, it passes through no model. Per
 264 subject we assemble the $13\,500 \times 18\,946$ matrix of per-TR voxel vectors and average the TRs whose
 265 centre time falls in $[wL + h, (w + 1)L + h)$, where h is a hemodynamic delay. As the released
 266 data are already hemodynamically aligned, we swept $h \in [0, 8]$ s and found $h = 0$ s to maximise
 267 alignment; all reported results use $h = 0$ s. This gives one voxel vector per window per subject, on
 268 the same grid as every other representation.

269 **Stimulus and subjects.** For a window of length L we concatenate the frames of every 4 s clip it
 270 overlaps and sample from that span: 16 frames uniformly for the video transformers, one frame per
 271 second for the image models, whose per-block class tokens are averaged over the window. Language
 272 input uses the Qwen-2.5-VL-7B caption CineBrain provides per clip; a window takes every caption it
 273 overlaps, concatenated in order, two for the 5, 6 and 8 s grids and three for the 10 s grid, embedded as
 274 layerwise masked mean-pools. When L is not a multiple of 4 s adjacent windows share a boundary
 275 clip and caption, inflating temporal autocorrelation, which the shift-null and block-permutation tests
 276 of the main text control for. Alignment scores are computed per subject and then averaged, so no
 277 similarity computation mixes subjects, whereas the interpretability analyses use subject-averaged
 278 embeddings and markers.

279 B Null calibration

280 Here we define the null used in this work, adapted from the i.i.d calibration of Gröger et al. [2026].

281 Stating this formally: let n be the number of windows in the grid, and let $C_n = \{c_d\}_{d=0}^{n-1}$ be the cyclic
 282 group whose elements rigidly rotate the window index,

$$c_d(\mathbf{Y})[i] = \mathbf{Y}[(i - d) \bmod n]. \quad (1)$$

283 That is, c_d moves the entry at position $i - d$ to position i : the whole sequence slides by d windows,
 284 and the $\bmod n$ returns what falls off the end to the front. The rotated sequence holds the same n
 285 vectors in the same cyclic order, so $\mathbf{Y}$'s own autocorrelation is left intact and its marginal distribution
 286 is identical; only its correspondence with $\mathbf{X}$ is destroyed, whereas a freea shuffle destroys both.

287 The cyclic group defines a strictly stronger null than the i.i.d. one:

H_0 : $\mathbf{X}$ and $\mathbf{Y}$ similarity at the true temporal pairing is no greater than at an arbitrary circular shift of one against the other.

Assumption 3.1 of Gröger et al. [2026] then reads $P_{H'_0}(\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{Y}) = P_{H'_0}(\mathbf{X}, c_d(\mathbf{Y}))$ for every $c_d \in C_n$, i.e. approximate circular stationarity of $\mathbf{Y}$.

Because we report the maximum alignment s over layer pairs, we follow the aggregation-aware calibration of Gröger et al. [2026, §5.2]: the *same* rotation is applied to every layer of B before the maximum is taken,

$$S_{\ell, \ell'}^{(d)} = s\left(\mathbf{X}_{\ell}^{(A)}, c_d\left(\mathbf{Y}_{\ell'}^{(B)}\right)\right), \quad T^{(d)} = \max_{\ell, \ell'} S_{\ell, \ell'}^{(d)}, \quad (2)$$

so the null retains the same selection advantage as the observed statistic.

Since c_0 is the identity, $T_{\text{obs}} = T^{(0)}$, and $|C_n| = n$ is small enough to enumerate exhaustively, so $K = n - 1$ is fixed by the number of windows rather than chosen and the right-tail permutation p -value

$$p = \frac{1 + \#\{d \neq 0 : T^{(d)} \geq T^{(0)}\}}{K + 1} \quad (3)$$

is exact rather than Monte Carlo, with floor $1/n$. We report as magnitude the excess over the null

$$\Delta = T^{(0)} - \frac{1}{n-1} \sum_{d=1}^{n-1} T^{(d)}. \quad (4)$$

in every alignment plot, whether it is mKNN or CKA. Δ is the “null-centered” calibration that Gröger et al. [2026, App. E.3] evaluate alongside their gated score and find to collapse correctly to the null baseline across all metrics; we prefer it here because it is α -free and, unlike their Eq. (17), commutes with the averaging over comparisons that our y axes perform in Figures 1, 3, 5 and 6. Evidence against H_0 is carried by p .

C NICE markers

The markers span three families: **(i) Spectral (11 markers)**: absolute (log) and normalised band powers in δ (1–4 Hz), θ (4–8 Hz), α (8–13 Hz) and β (13–30 Hz), plus spectral entropy, median spectral frequency and the 90% spectral edge frequency (SE_{90}), all computed from a Welch periodogram restricted to 1–30 Hz; **(ii) Information theory (3 markers)**: permutation entropy [Bandt and Pompe, 2002] of the broadband signal and of the θ - and α -filtered signals (embedding order 3, unit delay, normalised by $\log 3!$); **(iii) Complexity (2 markers)**: the Hjorth mobility and complexity parameters, i.e. the variance ratios of the signal and its first and second derivatives.

Each marker is computed per channel and then summarised as the median across the 64 EEG channels, yielding one scalar per marker per time window. Windows are non-overlapping and tile the recording from $t = 0$; their length matches the input window of the EEG model under comparison (5, 6, 8 or 10 s), so that marker vectors and model embeddings are defined on exactly the same temporal grid. The resulting per-window vectors are averaged across the six subjects, to match the subject-averaged embeddings. This produces a 16-dimensional embedding per window. Crucially, every dimension is interpretable by construction, corresponding to a specific marker whose clinical meaning has been established across years of research [Engemann et al., 2018].

D Models, grids and marker scores

Table 1 lists every EEG model, the grid it defines, its marker score, and its mean similarity to models of other families. Table 2 breaks the marker score down by marker.

Table 1: The 14 EEG models. Window and count give the grid each model defines natively; cross-model similarity is computed after resampling to the shared 10 s grid (1080 windows). The marker score is the mean R^2 over the sixteen EEG markers on subject-averaged data, and is the horizontal axis of Figures 1 and 3. Values are uncentred; the figures plot the same quantities after mean-centring within family.

Family	Size	Params (M)	Window (s)	Windows	Marker R^2	MKNN	CKA
FEMBA	tiny	8	5	2160	-0.154	0.057	0.136
FEMBA	base	48	5	2160	+0.023	0.061	0.215
FEMBA	large	78	5	2160	+0.015	0.060	0.203
LUNA	base	7	5	2160	+0.190	0.063	0.284
LUNA	large	43	5	2160	+0.284	0.073	0.279
LUNA	huge	311	5	2160	+0.325	0.070	0.283
NeuroLM	b	254	8	1350	+0.594	0.041	0.226
NeuroLM	l	500	8	1350	+0.560	0.040	0.215
NeuroLM	xl	1696	8	1350	+0.546	0.037	0.218
REVE	base	69	10	1080	+0.667	0.052	0.223
REVE	large	408	10	1080	+0.695	0.058	0.241
STEEGFormer	small	22	6	1800	+0.663	0.049	0.287
STEEGFormer	base	86	6	1800	+0.666	0.049	0.306
STEEGFormer	large	307	6	1800	+0.731	0.078	0.313

Table 2: The sixteen EEG markers, and how well the model embeddings predict them. Median and best R^2 are taken across the 14 EEG models. The three permutation entropy markers had non-positive median (R^2) across models, although some individual models predicted them above chance.

Marker	Median R^2	Best R^2	Best model
abs_delta	+0.466	+0.887	reve-base
rel_delta	+0.676	+0.768	reve-large
abs_theta	+0.232	+0.877	reve-large
rel_theta	+0.523	+0.631	steegformer-large
abs_alpha	+0.066	+0.824	reve-large
rel_alpha	+0.593	+0.671	steegformer-large
abs_beta	+0.046	+0.850	reve-large
rel_beta	+0.345	+0.827	steegformer-large
spec_entropy	+0.409	+0.719	steegformer-large
median_freq	+0.597	+0.756	steegformer-large
spec_edge90	+0.449	+0.786	steegformer-large
pe_broad	-0.275	+0.779	steegformer-large
pe_theta	-0.022	+0.198	neurolm-xl
pe_alpha	-0.025	+0.292	neurolm-b
hjorth_mobility	+0.660	+0.944	steegformer-large
hjorth_complexity	+0.584	+0.868	steegformer-large

323 E Intramodality Intra-architecture

324 For each family, we selected the two smallest models and the two largest, and measured the similarity
325 of each pair. Figure 4 shows how every family the larger pair is more aligned in mKNN, but only
326 FEMBA increases in CKA. We excluded REVE because it includes only two distinct sizes.

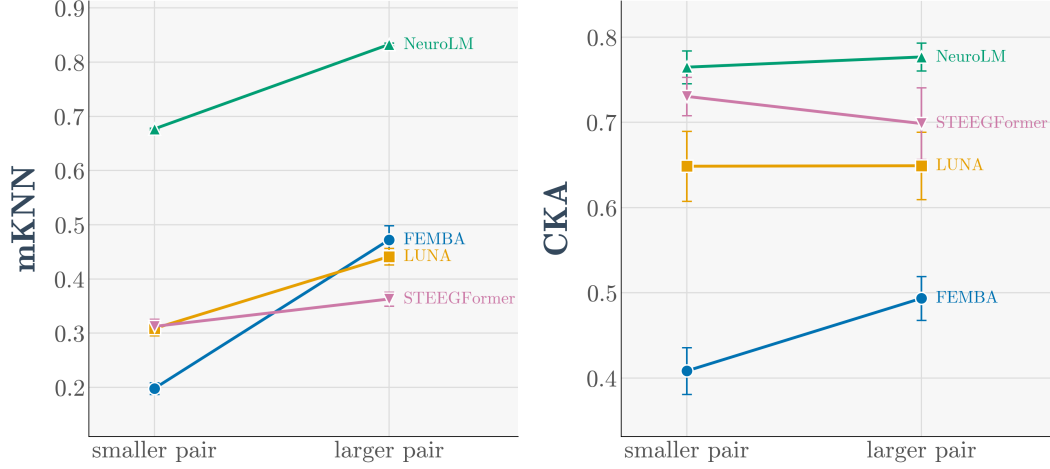


Figure 4: Similarity between two models of the same family, for the two smallest models and the two largest. Every family alignment rises locally but only FEMBA does globally.

327 F Crossmodality against every model: Vision and Language

328 Here we show the results obtained with OpenLLaMA in Figure 5 and with DINOv2, VideoMAE and
 329 VideoMAE-K400 in Figure 6, against NICE decodability. We observe consistent global alignment
 330 against language models.

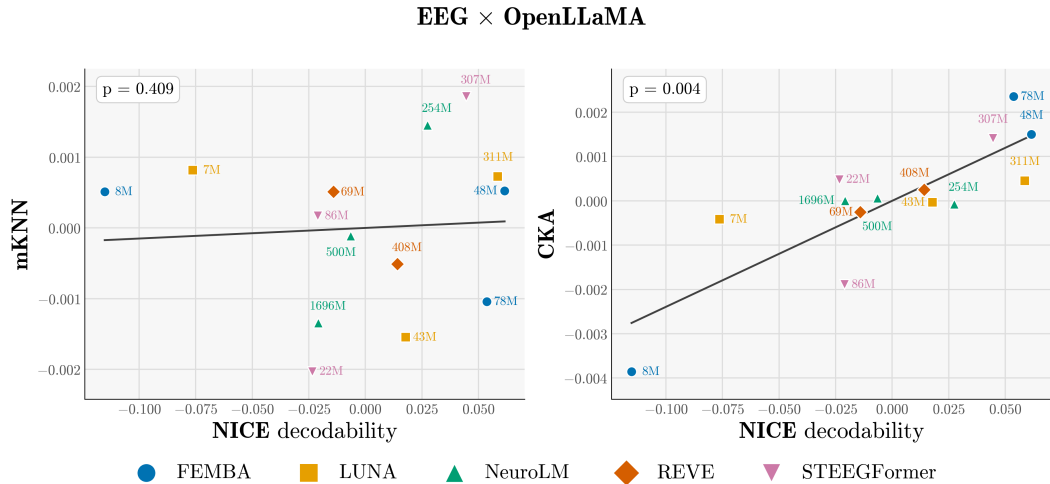


Figure 5: Individual points denote models; shape and colour indicate family, and labels indicate parameter count. *Vertical axis*: calibrated alignment averaged across the available OpenLLaMA sizes for the mKNN (left) and CKA (right). *Horizontal axis*: NICE decodability. Both axes are mean-centred within family. Each EEG model is paired with the partner tiled at its own window length ($W = 2160, 1800, 1350, 1080$ for the 5, 6, 8 and 10 s families), on subject-averaged EEG embeddings.

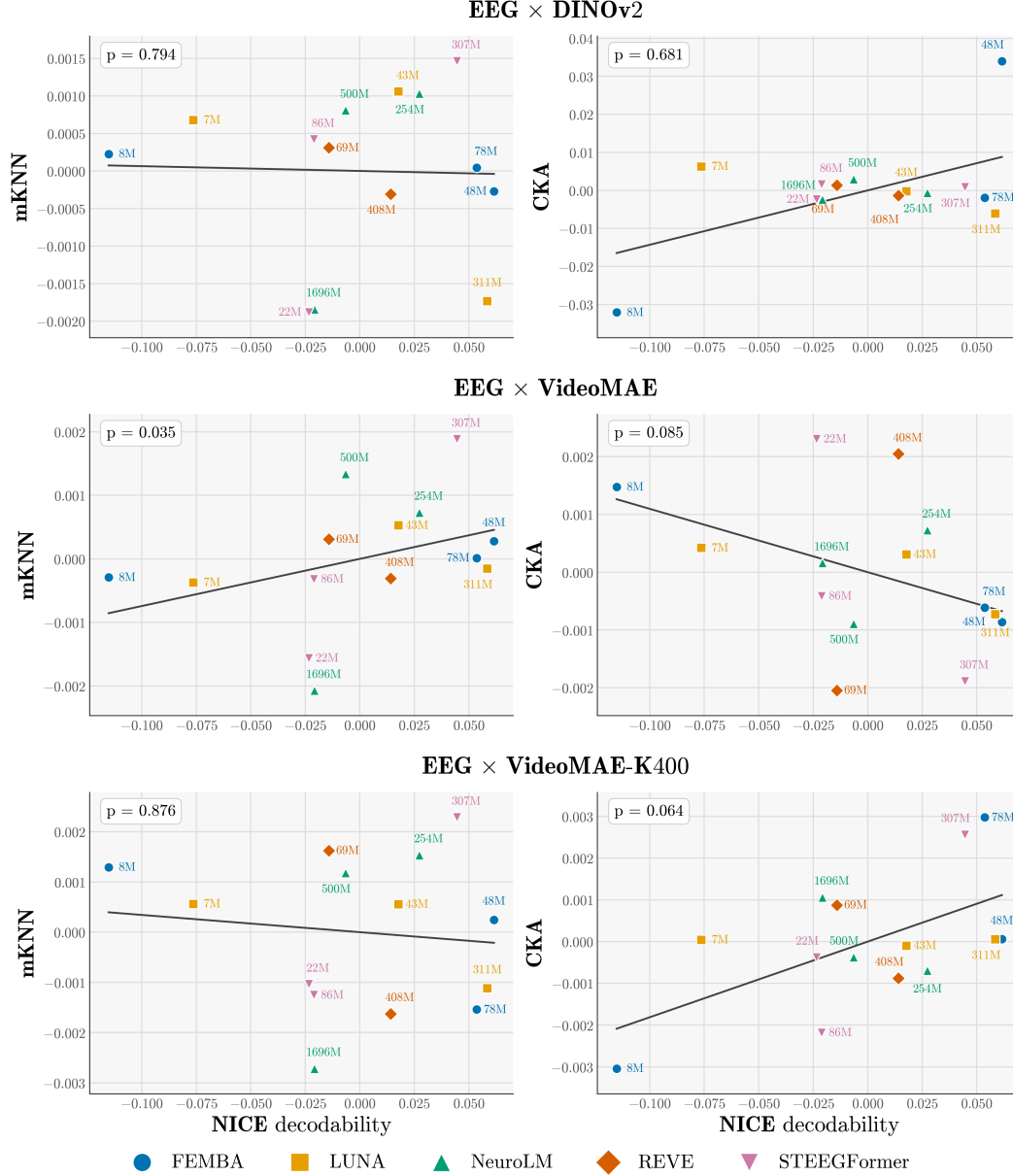


Figure 6: Individual points denote models; shape and colour indicate family, and labels indicate parameter count. *Vertical axis*: alignment calibrated averaged across all sizes of the indicated vision model family for the mKNN (left) and CKA (right). *Horizontal axis*: NICE decodability. Both axes are mean-centred within family. Each EEG model is paired with the partner tiled at its own window length ($W = 2160, 1800, 1350, 1080$ for the 5, 6, 8 and 10 s families), on subject-averaged EEG embeddings.

G EEG similarity to vision and language

Each EEG model is paired with each vision model on the EEG model’s own tiling and scored with mKNN in Figure 7 and with CKA in Figure 8, taking the best score over layer pairs and calibrating against the cyclic null. Two questions are separable here, and we treat them separately: whether alignment exists at all, and whether it grows with model capacity. Although they don’t always clear the null with $p > 0.05$, alignment between EEG models and models not trained on neural data therefore exists in many cases, but it doesn’t improve as the EEG models grow.

338 This may be explainable by the results of Koepke et al. [2026], where they argue that in a non-bijective
339 dataset the alignment seems to be more fragile. This seems to be valid in the CineBrain dataset, as all
340 stimuli come from the same series.

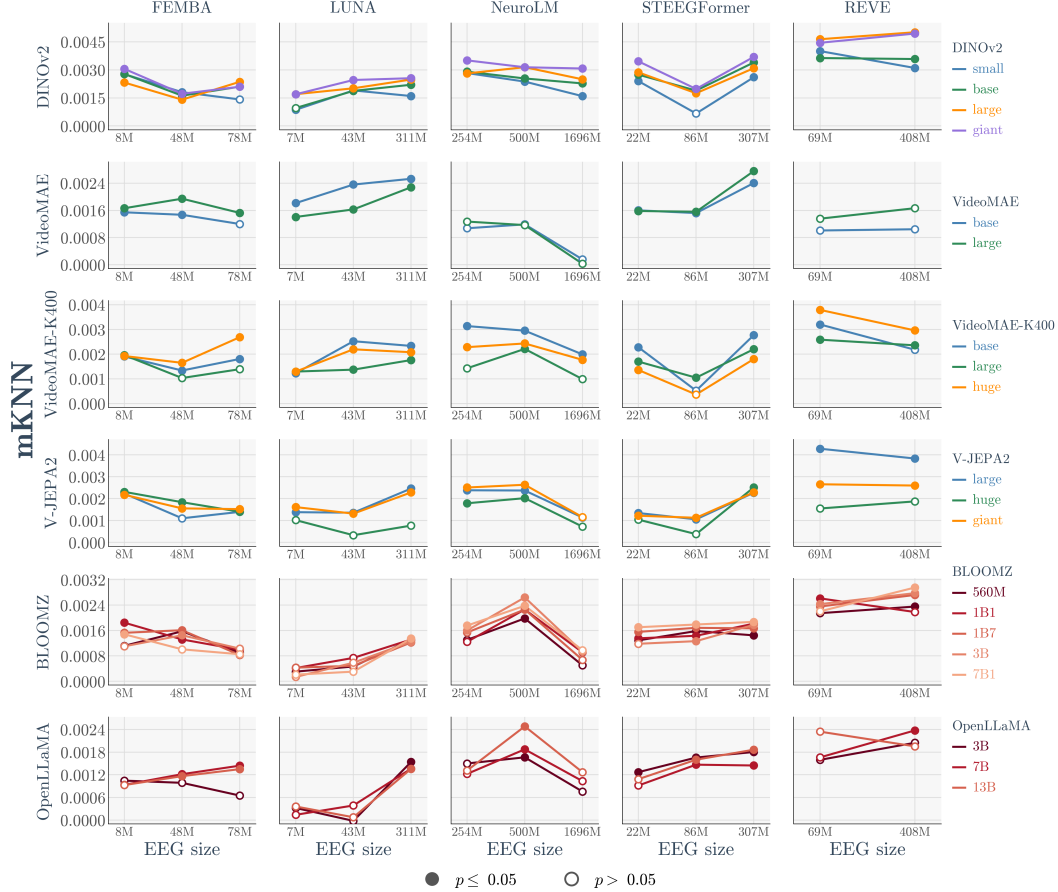


Figure 7: Each EEG model mKNN alignment to every vision and language model. Many clear the null but there is no correlation with model size.

341 H Alignment of vision and language models with fMRI

342 Figure 9 shows the alignment between fMRI and video and language models under mKNN. The
343 margin above the null is considerably larger than for EEG (Fig. 2). This is consistent with fMRI's
344 high spatial resolution and its well-documented capacity to encode rich semantic Huth et al. [2016]
345 and hierarchical visual Devereux et al. [2018] structure. Within each model family, however, the null
346 tracks the observed line almost exactly. As with EEG, what the larger model gains with model size is
347 shared temporal smoothness.

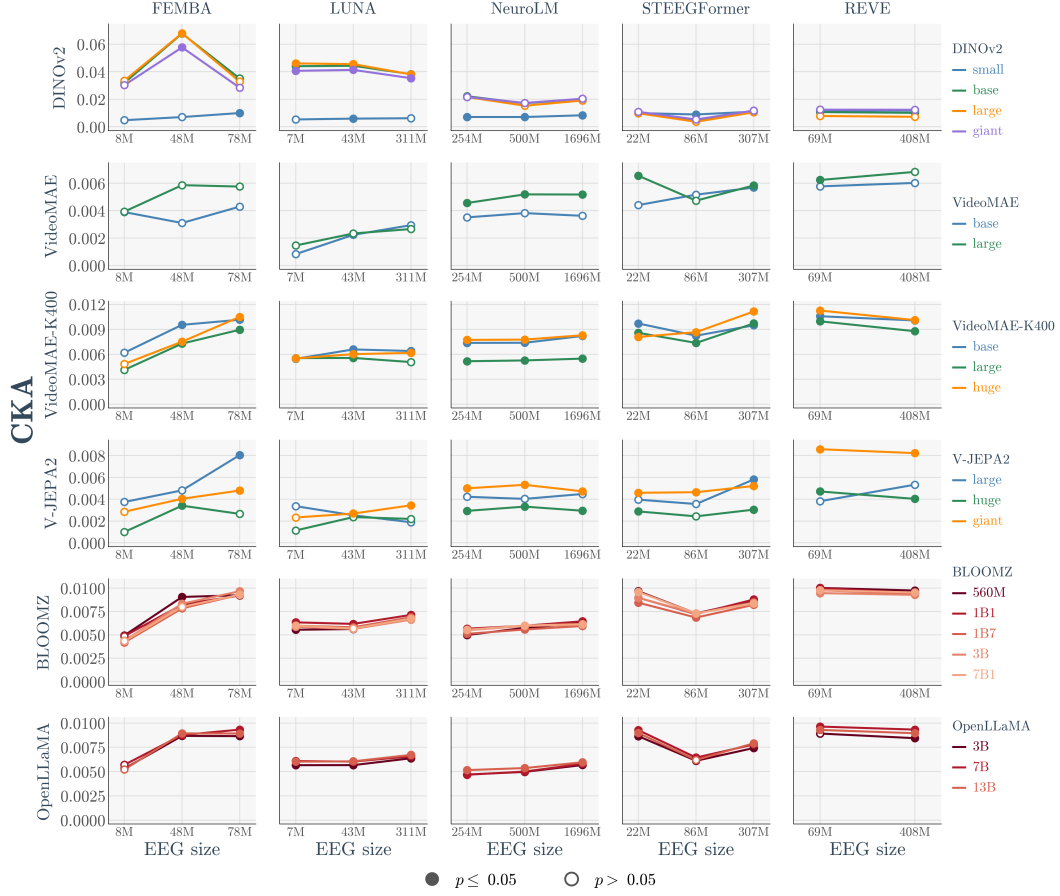


Figure 8: Each EEG model CKA alignment to every vision and language model. Many exceed the null but there is no correlation with model size.

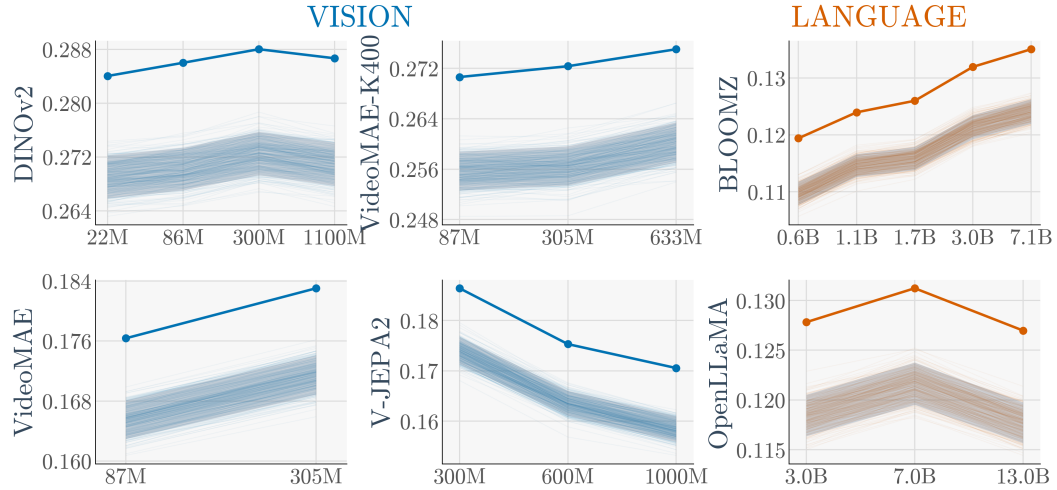


Figure 9: **mKNN alignment to brain activity against model size.** Similarity of each vision and language model to fMRI, plotted against parameter count. Solid coloured lines show observed mKNN at the true temporal pairing. The raw score changes with size, but the null tracks it closely.